

CUSTOMER & MVP BLUEPRINT

CleanRoute — Mobile Sanitation on Indian Highways

Source: CleanRoute Startup Validation Report (June 2025)

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PRE-SEED | INDIA | SANITATION & INFRASTRUCTURE

IDEA	PROBLEM	MARKET	COMPETITORS	VALIDATION
Mobile toilet vans on highways & hill routes	No clean toilets for road travellers in India	India National Highways & Hill Routes	NHAI Wayside HPCL Restrooms Sulabh (urban) Dhaba toilets	Zero — idea stage; founder lived the problem

01 EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

CleanRoute is a pre-seed mobile sanitation startup targeting India's 1.46 lakh km highway network. The founder identified a universal, high-urgency pain point: absence of clean, safe restrooms during road travel — felt acutely by families, women, and long-haul drivers. With near-zero organised competition and a massive addressable market (TAM Rs.18,000 Cr), the MVP priority is to **validate willingness to pay and unit economics with 1 van on a single corridor before any major capital deployment**. The core product to build first: a **reliable, clean, attended toilet van with UPI payment** — not an app, not a subscription, not a premium tier.

02 IDEAL CUSTOMER PROFILE

Segment	Who They Are	Frequency	WTP	Priority
Family Road Tripper	Nuclear family, 2+ kids, Tier-1/2 city, 4-8 hr drives	2-4x/yr	Rs.20-40	#1 Priority
Solo / Group Women	Safety-first; health-conscious; urban traveller	Monthly	Rs.30-50	#1 Priority
Long-Haul Trucker	16 hr daily shifts; no dignified option exists	Daily	Rs.10-15	#2 Priority
Hill-Station Tourist	Manali / Ooty / Darjeeling seasonal traveller	Seasonal	Rs.25-50	#2 Priority
Fleet / Logistics B2B	Corporate driver welfare pass; bulk billing	Always-on	Rs.500/mo	#1 B2B

03 BUYER PERSONAS

PRIYA, 34 — Family Traveller	RAJAN, 42 — Long-Haul Trucker
Location: Delhi NCR Income: Rs.12-18 LPA	Route: Mumbai-Delhi Shift: 16 hrs daily
Goal: Safe, comfortable family road trip	Goal: Predictable, dignified restroom on route
Pain: Daughter must use a bag in car — humiliating	Pain: Open defecation; no alternative exists on road
Trigger: Clean van with female attendant visible on highway	Trigger: Same van at same spot every day — reliable
WTP: Rs.30-40/use Rs.499/mo CleanPass	WTP: Rs.10-15/use Prefers cash/UPI, no app needed
Tech: Google Maps, Zomato, MakeMyTrip user	Key Need: Reliability over luxury every time

■ 04 TOP 10 CUSTOMER PAIN POINTS

#	Pain Point	Severity	Segment
1	Zero clean toilets for 50-200 km highway stretches	Critical	Everyone
2	Existing facilities biologically unsafe / filthy	Critical	Women, elderly, kids
3	Women's safety risk at isolated/night stops	Critical	Women travellers
4	UTIs from holding too long — chronic health risk	Critical	Women, children
5	No feminine hygiene products on any highway route	Critical	Women
6	Children get motion sick from holding discomfort	High	Families with kids
7	Truckers have zero dignified option on 16-hr shifts	High	Long-haul drivers
8	No way to know in advance where facilities are located	High	Trip planners
9	Inconsistent quality — cannot trust any roadside facility	Medium	Repeat travellers
10	No UPI/digital payment option at any roadside stop	Medium	Urban travellers

■ 05 CUSTOMER JOURNEY

Stage	Customer Action	Emotion	CleanRoute Touchpoint	Metric
Awareness	Sees van on highway / hears from friends	Curious	Find van, GMaps pin, social reels	Impressions
Consideration	Urgency hits; pulls over; sees hygiene attendant	Anxious to toilet	Hygiene rating board, female attendant	Stop rate
Purchase	Pays Rs.10-30 via UPI QR; enters van	Relieved	Frictionless UPI QR; coin slot backup	Conversion %
Retention	Experience is clean; scans QR for app	Delighted	In-van QR to app; CleanPass Rs.499/yr	VRP, repeats
Advocacy	Posts on travel group / leaves Google review	Proud	Easy review link; Rs.50 referral credit	Reviews, referrals

KEY OBJECTIONS & RESPONSES

Rs.20 for a toilet? Offer Rs.10 basic tier; compare to UTI treatment cost

Is it actually clean? Live hygiene score + 30-min log visible outside van

No change / cash UPI QR mandatory; coin slot optional on every van

What if van is not there? Fixed GPS spots; app shows live location

Safe for women? Female attendant + CCTV notice + lighting standard

I'll just use a field Dignity + health messaging on route signage

KEY BUYING TRIGGERS

Physical urgency — cannot wait any longer while driving

Travelling with kids, women, or elderly family member

Saw clean van with attendant and hygiene score on board

Found on Google Maps or recommended in travel group

Prior bad experience at dirty dhaba / petrol pump toilet

CleanPass subscription already purchased (B2B fleet)

■ 06 MVP RECOMMENDATION

Build First: 1 clean, well-lit, attended toilet van on Delhi-Chandigarh NH-44. UPI QR payment. Fixed GPS location. Female attendant. Hygiene score board. Operate 30 days. Measure usage, revenue, and NPS. **Nothing else.**

BUILD IN MVP	DO NOT BUILD YET
Clean functional toilet van (1 unit, leased)	Mobile app — users will just stop at the van directly
Attendant (female where possible) always present	CleanPass subscription product
UPI QR payment — Rs.10 / Rs.20 / Rs.30 tiers	Premium A/C cabin tier
Physical hygiene score board updated every hour	Multi-van fleet before unit economics proven
Fixed GPS-marked location on highway shoulder	FMCG vending machines inside the van
WhatsApp number displayed for feedback	Advertising display screens
Daily usage and revenue log in Google Sheet	Second corridor deployment

Success Metric	Day-30 Target	Why It Matters
Daily uses per van	>150 uses/day	Proves demand at this location
Revenue per van per day	>Rs.2,500/day	Unit economics viability
% users paying via UPI	>60%	Digital adoption and scale readiness
Net Promoter Score (NPS)	>50	Word-of-mouth potential
% women users	>35%	Validates women's safety comfort level
Return visitors (same van)	>20%	Habit formation and loyalty signal

■ 07 MoSCoW PRIORITIZATION

MUST HAVE — Launch Blockers	SHOULD HAVE — Next 60 Days
- Clean maintained van (leased or owned) - On-site attendant at all operating hours - UPI QR plus coin slot payment - Hygiene score board visible outside van - Fixed GPS-pinned highway location - Basic safety: lighting, lock, attendant	- Google Maps listing with photo and reviews - WhatsApp chatbot for location queries - Second van on same corridor - Feminine hygiene vending (low cost add-on) - Attendant SOP cleaning manual - Unit economics tracking dashboard
COULD HAVE — Post PMF	WON'T HAVE NOW — Future Vision
- CleanRoute mobile app with locator - Loyalty / CleanPass subscription - Premium A/C cabin option at Rs.50 - Corporate B2B fleet pass product - FMCG brand partnership vending	- Multi-city network across 10+ corridors - Fixed pod infrastructure (non-mobile) - In-van advertising display screens - Government PPP concession model - International market expansion

08 PRICING HYPOTHESIS

Tier	Price	Target	Includes	Est. Users
Basic	Rs.10	Truckers, budget	Toilet, water, soap	30%
Standard	Rs.20	Families, general	Basic + tissue + sanitiser	50%
Premium	Rs.40	Women, urban	Standard + feminine hygiene + assist	15%
CleanPass Monthly	Rs.499	Frequent travellers	Unlimited uses all CleanRoute vans	5% B2C
Fleet B2B Pass	Rs.400/driver/mo	Logistics companies	Driver welfare; bulk billing; SLA	B2B track

Unit Economics (1 van, Day-30 target): 150 uses/day x Rs.20 avg = Rs.3,000/day. Van lease Rs.25,000 + Attendant Rs.12,000 + Consumables Rs.8,000 = Rs.45,000/mo cost. Revenue Rs.90,000/mo. **Gross margin approx 50% — viable if usage hits 150/day. Break-even at 75 uses/day.**

09 TOP 5 RISKS

#	Risk	Level	Mitigation
1	NHAI authority blocks van parking on national highway	High	Approach toll authority NOW; explore dhaba land lease as fallback
2	Usage too low under 75/day to cover operational costs	Optimal	Choose highest-traffic corridor; foot survey before van deployment
3	Hygiene standards slip; brand reputation is destroyed	High	Strict SOPs; hourly cleaning log displayed; weekly mystery audits
4	Willingness to pay lower in practice vs survey results	Medium	Test with mock QR at roadside — get 30 real payment commitments first
5	Cannot hire reliable female attendants at scale	Medium	Partner with local women SHGs (NRLM); offer Rs.10-12K/mo plus tips

10 30-DAY MVP PLAN

Days	Action	Output	Owner
1-3	Drive Delhi-Chandigarh NH-44. Log every toilet. Count gaps	Gap map + GPS data	Founder
4-7	Interview 50 travellers at toll/dhaba. Confirm pain + WTB	50 surveys done	Founder + helper
7-10	Visit NHAI office. Ask about van parking / concession rights	Written/verbal OK	Founder
10-14	Mock QR test at highway — get strangers to commit to Rs.20 payments	30+ payments	Founder
12-16	Build landing page + Instagram. Post problem reel.	500 signups, 10K views	Founder/freelancer
15-20	Find and approach 3 ops/logistics co-founder candidates	2+ interested	Founder
18-22	Lease 1 van. Hire attendant. Set SOP. Deploy on corridor	Van live on road	Founder + ops
22-28	Operate daily. Track every use: count, tier, payment, location, NPS.	Live data, NPS	Founder + attendant
28-30	Review: revenue, NPS, permit status. GO or WAIT decision.	Decision document	Founder

11 FOUNDER ACTION SHEET — TOP 10 ACTIONS

#	Action	Deadline	Success Signal
1	Drive 1 corridor end-to-end; log every toilet location	Day 3	Gap map ready
2	Interview 50 travellers at toll/petrol pump — confirm pain + WTP	Day 5	30+ confirm Rs.20 WTP
3	Contact NHAI district office about van parking on highway	Day 10	Any written response
4	Run mock QR payment test at roadside with real stranger	Day 12	30 real commitments
5	Launch Instagram/Twitter — post problem-awareness reel	Day 14	10K views, 100+ DMs
6	Build simple landing page with email waitlist form	Day 14	500 email signups
7	Approach 3 ops/logistics co-founder candidates	Day 18	1 co-founder interested
8	Lease 1 van + hire 1 attendant; write cleaning SOP	Day 20	Van ready to operate
9	Apply to Atal Innovation Mission / StartupIndia Seed Fund	Day 25	2 applications done
10	Review all data — make GO (scale) or PIVOT (tweak) call	Day 30	Documented decision

12 VALIDATION SCORES

Dimension	Score	Progress Bar	Insight
Customer Clarity	72/100		Strong ICP identified; needs field interview confirmation
Problem Severity	95/100		Near-perfect — universal, urgent, daily pain on Indian roads
PMF Potential	78/100		Strong if unit economics proven; genuine blue ocean market
MVP Readiness	48/100		Zero validation done yet — complete 30-day sprint first

13 FINAL VERDICT

PROMISING BUT UNVALIDATED

CleanRoute solves a **real, severe, and massive** problem with near-zero competition. Every Indian who has driven a highway has felt this pain. However, **zero market validation has been done yet**. Before spending on a van, confirm: (1) travellers will pay, (2) a parking permit is obtainable, and (3) unit economics work at realistic usage levels. Complete the 30-day sprint. If 3 of 4 success metrics are met, **immediately upgrade to STRONG GO**.

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"A clean toilet on every highway is not a luxury — it is dignity. Build the simplest version. Prove it works. Then scale fast."

— CleanRoute Customer & MVP Blueprint | AI Product Manager Report
